

Exercise 10: Branches

For this exercise, you will create a new branch, list all branches, push your branch, and delete your branch.

Note that the default branch used to be called “master”, but is now called “main.” If you created your repository before Oct 2020, it might be called “master”.

Create a New Branch

1. Open your terminal console and change directory into your repository, if it’s not there already.
2. Create a new branch called **instructions** which will hold some instructions for the toothbrush.

```
git checkout -b instructions
```

3. List all of your branches and notice that the **instructions** branch is listed, and there is a star next to it.

```
git branch
```

4. Open your editor. Add a new paragraph with some instructions. For example, it could say, “Turn on the toothbrush using the green button. Place in your mouth.”
5. Go back to the terminal console. Save, add, and commit.
6. Now push it to GitHub. Remember, you will need a special command to say that you want to create a new branch on GitHub called instructions that tracks to the branch you just created. You can see what this command is by simply typing:

```
git push origin
```

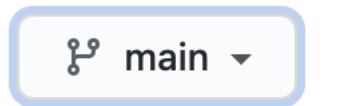
7. This will return a message saying that there is no GitHub branch associated with the local branch that you are on, and it will suggest a new command. Copy and paste this command:

```
git push --set-upstream origin instructions
```

8. Use the `git checkout` command to return to the main branch.
9. Do a `git branch` command to verify that you are on the main branch.
10. Open up your editor and verify that your instructions paragraph is not there because you are no longer on the instructions branch.
11. Return to the instructions branch. Again open the editor and verify that your instructions paragraph is back.

View Branch on GitHub

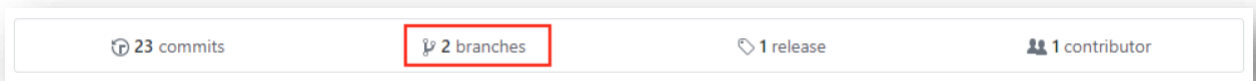
1. Open your repository on GitHub in the browser. Click on **docs.md**, if it's not already open. You should see the version on the main branch.
2. Click the dropdown where it says **main**.



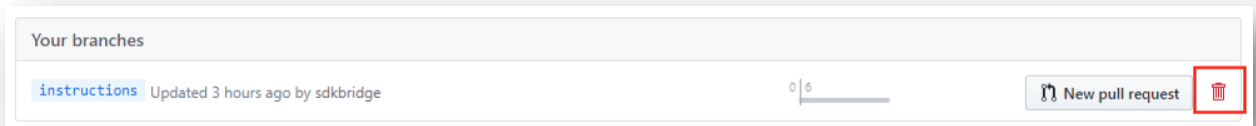
3. Choose **instructions**. Now your docs.md file should show the instructions paragraph.

Delete the Branch

1. In the browser, go to the top of your repository by clicking the **exercise** link at the top.
2. Click on where it says **2 branches** to see all the branches:



3. To the right of where it says **instructions**, click on the red trash can.



4. Now you've deleted it on GitHub. You still need to delete it locally. Go back to your terminal console and switch back to the main branch using `git checkout main`
5. Delete the branch using the `-d` flag. (Note: if you get any kind of error, try the `-D` flag with a capital D. This will force it to be deleted.)

```
git branch -d instructions
```

6. Type `git branch` to verify that it's deleted.